really have been fortunate.[3] And my peers Vivek, Yogi, Lajpat and Ramesh with whom I had many an escapade; including driving the CO's jeep past the CO himself! The Adjutant's 'Secret' almirah used to be full of Warning Letters administered to us—I hope they have been preserved.

Not to forget my personal staff, especially during my Chief's tenure. Brig Vikrant Naik, the MA, Cols Katoch and Devvrat, the AMAs and the ADCs, Capt Taran, Muthappa, Vasim and Navin, who together made sure I reached the right place at the right time—and in the right frame of mind. The officers in the Chief's KRA cell, Brigs Rajiv Gadihoke and Mohit Seth and Cols Kuhite and Palande, who followed up on all my Key Result Areas for fructification. I have always believed that a Commander is only as good as his Staff and vice versa. If the Staff is timid, so will be the Commander. If the Commander is bureaucratic, the Staff will also indulge in nitpicking. I was fortunate to have an excellent team, always on the lookout to see how to get the work done.

At the foundation of all this are our gallant jawans, whose safety, honour and welfare we are committed to uphold. Whether one is an extrovert who can strike a rapport with the men through backslapping bonhomie or through little acts of kindness, the men instinctively know who is for them and who is just putting on a show. We have to remember that when we as Young Officers join the unit, they have to accept us and not the other way around. Once at a unit reunion at Ambala, I was with a group of retired JCOs, reminiscing about the 'good old times'—the 1980s, and how pay used to be distributed in cash, down to even ten rupees—no rounding off. During one such pay-parade, one of the jawans had turned obstinate. He wanted to go on leave, and the pay he was getting—may be some 200-odd rupees, not being enough, he wanted more. The

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